COLTON RANDALL

BACKEND SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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SUMMARY

Backend-focused software engineer with nearly five years shipping production systems in messaging (Sinch), banking (Westpac) and SaaS (Xero). Java, Spring and AWS day to day, with a full-stack background in C#/.NET and React. Promoted three times in under three years at Xero and won its internal hackathon. Known for raising test coverage, owning services end to end and mentoring engineers.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer II
Mar 2026 - Present

Sinch · Melbourne, Australia

- Raised Short URL length limits, cutting "URL too long" errors in the dead letter queue by about 90% and freeing up developer time.
- Added rate limiting to sender throttling so messages flow evenly through the pipeline.
- Key contributor to migrating our services and components to Sinch's US instance.
- Restructured the messaging infrastructure to support WhatsApp usernames.
- Upgraded our RDS PostgreSQL database three major versions (15 → 18).
- Led and pitched the team's hackathon entry, syncing provider config between Confluence and GitLab.
- Run incident fire drills, buddy new starters, and drove our rebrand to Sinch Engage.

`Java · Spring · AWS (ECS, RDS, SQS) · CloudFormation · Docker · GitLab`

`Relocated Auckland → Melbourne, Mar 2026`

Software Engineer
Apr 2025 - Mar 2026

Westpac New Zealand · Auckland

- Shipped transaction enrichment and document download features end to end, from REST API design to production.
- Raised test coverage from 60% to 80% while modernising legacy backend services.
- Built Java SDK features that standardised internal APIs across the bank.
- Designed Payments and Customer Alerts systems with solutions architects. Mentored junior engineers.
- Built Azure and Terraform infrastructure alongside platform teams.

`Java 17 · Spring Boot · REST · Kubernetes · Azure · Terraform`

Software Engineer
Nov 2021 - Apr 2025

Xero · Auckland · promoted three times

Intermediate Engineer — Jul 2024 - Apr 2025
Won the internal hackathon with a Chart of Accounts export that shipped to production. Raised automated test coverage 40% across legacy React code. Improved New Relic monitoring to cut incident detection time.

Associate Engineer — Feb 2023 - Jul 2024
Built REST APIs and serverless AWS (Lambda, S3, DynamoDB) for six migration tools used by thousands of customers. Mentored a graduate and led incident response.

Graduate Engineer — Feb 2022 - Feb 2023
Delivered full-stack features across several teams, grounded in TDD, pairing and code review.

Intern — Nov 2021 - Feb 2022
Parallelised API calls to speed up a service and moved feature flags into a decoupled service.

`C# / .NET · React · TypeScript · AWS · MySQL · Docker · Kubernetes`

Bioinformatics Research Assistant
Jul 2020 - Mar 2021

Landcare Research and University of Auckland

- Used Python for genome assembly, molecular simulations and data quality work supporting three PhD students.

EDUCATION

Postgraduate Certificate in IT · University of Auckland · Certificate of Outstanding Achievement — 2021

Master of IT, one semester · University of Auckland · AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner — 2021

BSc Biochemistry · University of Otago — 2015 - 2018

SKILLS

Languages
Java (8 to 25), C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL

Frameworks
Spring, Spring Boot, .NET, React, Next.js, JPA

AWS
ECS, RDS, DynamoDB, Lambda, S3, SQS, EC2

Infrastructure as code
CloudFormation, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes

Messaging & architecture
Queue-driven pipelines, rate limiting, dead letter queues, microservices, REST API design

Data & search
PostgreSQL, MySQL, DynamoDB, OpenSearch

Testing
JUnit, Mockito, Spring Test, Cucumber, WireMock, Jest, Cypress

CI/CD
Buildkite, GitHub Actions, GitLab, Jenkins, TeamCity, Octopus Deploy, SonarQube

Observability
Datadog, New Relic, Splunk, Sumo Logic

PROJECTS

SMS Routing Service ↗
`Java 21 · Spring Boot · CI`
Carrier routing by prefix, opt-outs, delivery tracking.

Task Manager API ↗
`Java 21 · Spring Boot · Docker`
REST API with JPA, domain events and CI/CD.

Discover Weekly Saver ↗
`Java · Spring Security · OAuth2`
Saves Spotify's weekly playlist before it resets.

AI Code Explainer ↗
`Next.js · TypeScript · LLM API`
Explains code in plain English. Live on Vercel.

BEYOND CODE

Private pilot licence, photography, guitar and leathercraft.